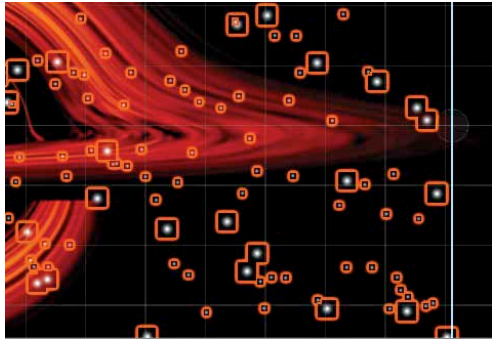


player's ship and the black hole. To do this, we will be creating our own particle generator. Right click on the Hierarchy panel, then go to **Effects > Particle System**. A shower of particles will start emanating from the middle of the black hole. Rename the Particle System GameObject to `background_stars`.

We are going to use this particle effect to generate stars, which will give the player the illusion of a moving background. There are various other ways of making a scrolling background, including using a textured rotating cylinder, or a script to make a tiled image perpetually scroll in the background. Now, we do not need to use a Sprite Renderer Component on the particle generator, and in fact, we cannot. The generator has a Renderer Component by default. A particle generator is a large and complex Game Object, with many attributes and values to tweak. Go to the very bottom of the list, and expand the Renderer subsection.

Towards the bottom of the list, change the Sorting Layer Id to Background, and then change the Order in Layer to -20. If you change it to -51, it will actually be behind the



A closeup of the two rectangular practical generators

animated background, and you will not be able to see it. Close the Renderer subsection of the Component. Next, go to the Shape subsection, and expand it. By default, the shape is set to Cone. This is the shape from which the particles stream out. Change the shape to rectangle. Now, increase the X value by a bit, then select the Rotate tool, and turn around the particle generator by 90 degrees counterclockwise. The idea is to place it at the right of the screen, with the particles streaming towards the left.

This will provide the illusion that the spaceship is constantly moving towards the right. To make sure that the generator is rotated by exactly 90 degrees, press and hold Ctrl while rotating, which snaps the angle every fifteen degrees. Drag the particle generator just off screen to the right. Now, expand the X value in the scale attribute till it occupies the entire screen vertically. This generator is creating the background stars, so we need a